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pykoop: a Python Library for Koopman Operator Approximation

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Summary

pykoop is a Python package for learning differential equations in discretized form using the Koopman operator. Differential equations are an essential tool for modelling the physical world. Ordinary differential equations can be used to describe electric circuits, rigid-body dynamics, or chemical reaction rates, while the fundamental laws of electromagnetism, fluid dynamics, and heat transfer can be formulated as partial differential equations. The Koopman operator allows nonlinear differential equations to be rewritten as infinite-dimensional linear differential equations by viewing their time evolution in terms of an infinite number of nonlinear lifting functions. A finite-dimensional approximation of the Koopman operator can be identified from data given a user-selected set of lifting functions. Thanks to its linearity, the approximate Koopman model can be used for analysis, design, and optimal controller or observer synthesis for a wide range of systems using well-established linear tools. pykoop's documentation, along with examples in script and notebook form, can be found at at pykoop.readthedocs.io/en/stable. Its releases are also archived on Zenodo (Dahdah & Forbes, 2024b).

Statement of need

Designing Koopman lifting functions for a particular system is largely a trial-and-error process. As such, pykoop is designed to facilitate experimentation with Koopman lifting functions, with the ultimate goal of automating the lifting function optimization process. The pykoop library addresses three limitations in current Koopman operator approximation software packages. First, pykoop allows lifting functions to be constructed in a modular fashion, specifically through the composition of a series of lifting functions. Second, the library allows regressor hyperparameters and lifting functions to be selected automatically through full compatibility with `scikit-learn`'s (Pedregosa et al., 2011) existing cross-validation infrastructure. Third, pykoop handles datasets with control inputs and multiple training episodes at all stages of the pipeline. Furthermore, pykoop implements state-of-the-art Koopman operator approximation methods that enforce stability in the identified system, either through direct constraints on its eigenvalues or by regularizing the regression problem using its $\mathcal{H}_\infty$ norm (Dahdah & Forbes, 2022).

Open-source Python libraries for Koopman operator approximation include `PyKoopman` (Pan et al., 2024), `DLKoopman` (Dey & Davis, 2023), and `kooplearn` (Novelli & Kostic, 2023). While `PyKoopman` provides a similar selection of lifting functions to pykoop, it does not allow lifting functions to be composed. Furthermore, the library does not include built-in functionality to handle multiple training episodes. Unlike pykoop, which focuses on discrete-time, `PyKoopman` is able to identify continuous-time Koopman operators. As such, the library includes several built-in numerical differentiation methods. Neural network lifting functions are also supported by `PyKoopman`. The `DLKoopman` library focuses on learning Koopman models using only neural network lifting functions, which are not implemented in pykoop. The library supports multiple

training episodes but does not support exogenous inputs and does not follow the `scikit-learn` interface. The `kooplearn` library includes kernel and neural network approaches to learning Koopman models, but does not include other types of lifting functions. While multiple training episodes are handled by `kooplearn`, exogenous inputs are not.

Scholarly publications using pykoop

The Koopman operator regression methods proposed in Dahdah & Forbes (2022) have been implemented within pykoop, while the methods proposed in Dahdah & Forbes (2024a), Lortie et al. (2024), Lortie & Forbes (2025), and Dahdah & Forbes (2024c) are all based on pykoop, but are implemented in their own repositories.

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